Jamaloden Basar

Atty. Jamaloden A. Basar is a Bangsamoro lawyer, educator, and academic administrator who currently serves as Superintendent/Chancellor of the Mindanao State University Maigo College of Education, Science and Technology (MSU-MCEST) in Maigo, Lanao del Norte, Philippines.

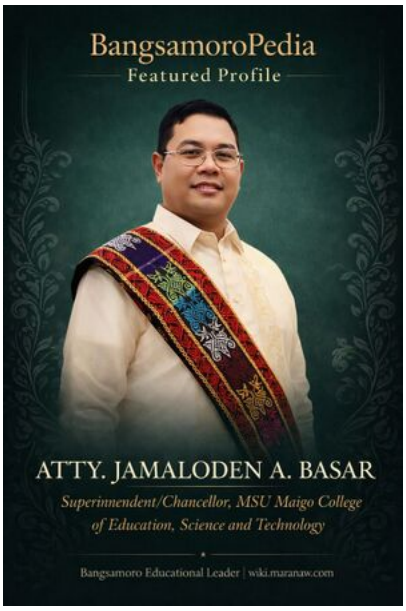
He brings more than three decades of combined legal and administrative experience to the role, having served in various capacities across the MSU System, from campus-level publication work all the way up to the system-wide vice presidency for administration and finance.

Basar is perhaps best known for leading the historic transformation of the MSU Maigo School of Arts and Trades (MSU-MSAT) into a full college, a milestone that had never been achieved in that campus's history, and for building a culture of academic excellence that has produced some of the country's top-performing teachers in the Licensure Examination for Teachers (LET).

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Atty. Jamaloden A. Basar



Born	Madalum, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Religion	Islam
Nationality	Filipino
Education	Juris Doctor, Mindanao State University College of Law
Occupation	Educator, Lawyer, Academic Administrator
Known for	Transformation of MSU-MSAT into MSU-MCEST; consistent LET topnotchers; MSU System VP for Administration and Finance
Current position	Superintendent/Chancellor, Mindanao State University Maigo College of Education, Science and Technology (MSU-MCEST)

Early Life and Background

Jamaloden A. Basar was born and raised in Madalum, a municipality in the interior of Lanao del Sur, the heartland of the Maranao people and one of the predominantly Muslim provinces in Mindanao.

Growing up in Madalum instilled in him the values that would define his career: a grounded sense of community, a drive to prove that young people from rural Bangsamoro areas could compete and excel on the national stage, and a practical understanding of what inclusive public service really means.

He completed his elementary education at Madalum Central Elementary School (MCES) in Madalum, Lanao del Sur, from 1976 to 1982, graduating with honors.

Education

Secondary

Basar pursued his secondary education at the MSU University Training Center (MSU-UTC) in Marawi City, completing the course from 1982 to 1986.

He distinguished himself early, earning recognition as an Outstanding Student and Leadership Awardee, a fitting preview of the institutional leadership roles he would eventually take on.

Tertiary

For his undergraduate degree, he stayed within the MSU ecosystem, enrolling at MSU Main Campus in Marawi City, where he pursued a Bachelor of Arts in Political Science from 1986 to 1990.

He graduated as a consistent academic scholar, a recognition reserved for students who maintained strong academic standing across all semesters.

The political science foundation proved especially useful later in his career, giving him a solid grounding in governance theory, public administration, and legal philosophy that complemented his eventual legal training.

Juris Doctor

After finishing his undergraduate degree, Basar took up law at the MSU Main College of Law in Marawi City, completing the Juris Doctor program from 1991 to 1994.

He graduated as a Dean's Lister, placing him among the top students in his law class.

He later passed the Philippine Bar Examinations administered by the Supreme Court of the Philippines in October 2009, earning the right to practice law and subsequently becoming a member of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP).

Career

Early Career: Publications and Administration at MSU (1994--2012)

Basar's professional life began not in the courtroom but in the newsroom, or at least the campus publication office.

From 1994 to 2004, he served as Information Officer II and Head of the Official Publication at the Office of the President of Mindanao State University in Marawi City.

This decade-long stint was formative. Managing a university's official publication required not just writing skills but institutional awareness, diplomatic communication, and a nose for what matters in academic governance. It was, in many ways, an extended apprenticeship in understanding how a complex university system actually works from the inside.

From 2004 to 2012, he moved into administrative work, serving as Administrative Officer IV at the same MSU Office of the President.

In this role, he handled executive-level administrative tasks under the university's top leadership, gaining direct exposure to how major institutional decisions were made, how budgets were managed, and how the MSU System as a whole was run.

Private Practice and Legal Work (2012--2016)

Between 2012 and 2016, Basar transitioned into a period of parallel engagements that combined private law practice with institutional legal work.

He managed the Basar Law Office, based in New Capitol, Bangon, Marawi City, where he handled cases and legal matters as a practicing attorney.

Simultaneously, he served as Legal Counsel and Member of the Board of Directors at the Philippine Integrated School in Marawi City, and as Head Legal Counsel at the Masiricampo Abantas Memorial Islamic and Science Academy, also in Marawi City.

These concurrent roles allowed him to build a reputation as a reliable legal mind within the Marawi and Bangsamoro institutional community, particularly in the education sector.

University Legal Counsel, MSU Main Campus (2016--2017)

In 2016, Basar rejoined the MSU System in a formal capacity, this time as University Legal Counsel and Director of the Legal Services Division at the MSU Main Campus Legal Office in Marawi City.

In this role, he successfully defended the university in various legal cases, protecting the institution's interests at a time when higher education governance in the Philippines was increasingly subject to legal scrutiny and accountability demands.

His tenure as legal counsel was brief, running only until 2017, but it solidified his standing within the MSU hierarchy as both a capable lawyer and a trustworthy institutional insider.

MSU System Vice President for Administration and Finance (2017--2021)

Basar's most senior executive role before his current assignment came when he was appointed SUC Vice-President IV, serving as the MSU System's Vice President for Administration and Finance from 2017 to 2021.

At this level, he was responsible for overseeing the fiscal and administrative operations of the entire MSU System, a sprawling network of constituent universities and colleges spread across Mindanao, Sulu, and Palawan.

One of his signature initiatives during this period was the conceptualization and launch of the Annual University System-wide Finance Summit, a regular convening designed to promote sound fiscal management and operational efficiency across all MSU campuses.

The Finance Summit was more than a meeting. It created a shared culture of fiscal accountability and best practices among the diverse units of the MSU System, helping to standardize how resources were managed and reported across campuses that often operated in very different local contexts.

During this period, he also served concurrently as Assistant Dean of the College of Law at the MSU-General Santos Extension (2018--2020), and took on the chairmanship of the MSU System Athletic Association (MSU SAA) beginning in 2018, a position he continues to hold.

Law Professor, MSU Main College of Law (2021--2022)

Following his tenure as VP for Administration and Finance, Basar served as a Law Professor at the MSU Main College of Law in Marawi City from 2021 to 2022.

Teaching law at the institution where he himself had been a Dean's Lister completed a meaningful circle in his professional story, one that moved from student to executive administrator to teacher.

Superintendent/Chancellor, MSU-MCEST (2024--Present)

In 2024, Basar was designated as Superintendent/Chancellor of what was then known as the MSU Maigo School of Arts and Trades (MSU-MSAT), a constituent college of the MSU System located in Maigo, Lanao del Norte in Northern Mindanao.

He inherited a campus with a solid tradition of technical and vocational education and the aspiration to grow into something more comprehensive.

Under his leadership, the campus undertook a historic institutional transformation: MSU-MSAT was formally renamed the MSU Maigo College of Education, Science and Technology (MSU-MCEST), reflecting a major expansion of its academic identity, programs, and ambitions.

This was a first in the campus's history. The new name signaled a shift away from the institution's original arts-and-trades focus toward a broader mandate that now includes education programs, science disciplines, and technology-oriented courses.

> "MSU-MCEST is a globally recognized institution in education, science, and technology, committed to advancing instruction, research, innovations, peace and development."

The transformation was not merely cosmetic. It involved a rethinking of what the campus could offer to the communities of Northern Mindanao and the broader Bangsamoro region, and what kind of graduates it wanted to produce for an increasingly complex world.

Academic Excellence and the LET Topnotchers

One of the most visible markers of MSU-MCEST's rise under Basar's stewardship is its consistent production of national topnotchers in the Licensure Examination for Teachers (LET).

Since his involvement with the campus, MSU-MCEST has placed graduates in the Top 10 of the LET multiple times: Top 1 in 2025, Top 4 in 2024, Top 2 in 2022, and Top 7 in 2017, all national rankings across the entire Philippines.

For a campus the size and relative remoteness of MSU-MCEST, these results are extraordinary. They reflect not just strong individual students, but the kind of systematic investment in instruction quality, faculty development, and student preparation that takes years to build.

The Commission on Higher Education (CHED) formally recognized the campus's achievement in 2022, awarding a Certificate of Recognition for excellence in instruction and training that resulted in a graduate placing in the Top 10 of the June 2022 LET (Elementary). This recognition is part of the broader track record Basar has been building at the campus level since his connection to it.

International Engagements

Beyond campus administration, Basar has represented the MSU System and MSU-MCEST on several international platforms.

He led a delegation to Malaysia in 2018 for the establishment of academic linkages in Malacca, and represented Mindanao State University at Universiti Sains Malaysia in Penang in 2017.

As Superintendent of MSU-MCEST, he has delivered official remarks during Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) signing ceremonies at Universitas Tanjungpura in Malaysia and at Tan Trao University in Vietnam, expanding the campus's network of international academic partnerships.

He has also served as a keynote speaker at various international academic institutions, positioning MSU-MCEST as a credible participant in regional higher education dialogue.

Research and Publications

Basar has pursued scholarly work alongside his administrative responsibilities.

He authored a research study entitled "Digital Marketing and Islamic Financing Among Muslim Women Micro-entrepreneurs for Sustainable Peace and Development," a work that sits at the intersection of economic empowerment, Islamic finance principles, and the ongoing peace-and-development agenda in Mindanao.

He also presented this research paper at an academic forum and received a Certificate of Appreciation for the presentation, signaling peer recognition of the study's contribution to the field.

He has participated in the 12th ASEAN Universities International Conference on Islamic Finance (AICIF), among other academic and professional convening, further deepening his engagement with Islamic finance as both a scholarly and practical domain.

Legal Practice and Professional Membership

Basar is a member of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP), having successfully passed the Bar Examinations given by the Supreme Court of the Philippines in October 2009.

He is also a member of the Mu Kappa Phi National Exclusive Law Fraternity, a brotherhood of legal professionals dedicated to excellence, integrity, and service in the legal profession.

Recognition and Awards

Over the course of his career, Basar has received a wide range of formal recognitions from government agencies, academic institutions, and community organizations.

He was issued a Certificate of Commendation of Merit by Mindanao State University (MSU) for his service as part of the MSU Crisis Team during the Marawi Siege, a particularly significant recognition given the gravity of that conflict and the extraordinary demands placed on MSU personnel during and after the siege.

The Commission on Higher Education (CHED) awarded him a Certificate of Recognition for excellence in instruction and training in connection with the 2022 LET topnotcher produced by MSU-MCEST.

The Local Government Unit of Maigo honored him with both a Plaque of Recognition for lifetime achievement and the Most Outstanding Maigohanon Award for exemplary service, lasting accomplishments, and dedication to public welfare, recognitions that reflect how deeply his work has been felt in the local community of Maigo.

The National Intelligence Coordinating Agency (NICA) awarded him a Certificate of Commendation for his contribution to an Information Drive on Preventing Violent Extremism and CTG Awareness, underscoring his engagement with national security and counter-radicalization efforts.

He received a Plaque of Recognition from the MSU System for participation in the Rawaten Cultural Gala during the 63rd System Foundation Celebration, and a Plaque of Appreciation for support during the 60th Founding Anniversary of MSU.

The Department of Health (DOH) recognized him for his support of the Voluntary Blood Donation program, and the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT) recognized MSU-MCEST under his leadership as an institutional partner of the ICT Literacy and Competency Development Bureau (ILCDB).

TESDA Region X acknowledged the campus's participation in the 2023 Regional Skills Competition in Northern Mindanao, and MSU-IIT NMPC honored him for collaboration in support of inclusive financial services aligned with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

The MSU-MSAT Faculty Union awarded him a Plaque of Appreciation for exceptional leadership and contributions to the campus's academic and physical development, and MSU-MSAT itself issued multiple Plaques of Commendation recognizing his stewardship from his earliest days as campus head.

Regional recognition also came when Basar was identified by the Regional Development Council of Region X as one of the Outstanding Young Leaders in Northern Mindanao in 2021.<ref name="msumsat-officials">Campus Officials. MSU Maigo. Retrieved from https://msumsat.edu.ph/home/campus-officials.php</ref>

In 2022, he was reportedly conferred the prestigious Ten Outstanding Young Men (TOYM) award, which recognizes Filipinos who have made significant contributions in their respective fields and communities.<ref name="msumsat-officials" />

Community and Institutional Service

Basar's record of service extends beyond the walls of academia.

He has served as a guest speaker at the MSU University Training Center's (MSU-UTC) 10th Completion Exercise, connecting with the secondary-level institution that shaped his own early formation.

He has been involved in the ASEAN 2022 Commemorative Event and Cultural Showcase, participating in regional cultural and diplomatic engagement.

His campus has also partnered with multiple agencies for skills training, blood donation drives, anti-extremism information campaigns, and ICT literacy programs, reflecting a philosophy that a university's responsibility doesn't end at the campus gate.

Legacy

Atty. Jamaloden A. Basar's career is a study in institutional loyalty and steady, earned advancement.

He didn't arrive at the chancellorship of MSU-MCEST from the outside. He grew up within the MSU System, learned its rhythms as a publications officer, mastered its administrative mechanics, defended it in court, managed its finances at the system level, and taught in its law school. By the time he was entrusted with transforming one of its campuses, he already knew the institution from nearly every angle possible.

The transformation of MSU-MSAT into MSU-MCEST, the first such institutional elevation in that campus's history, stands as his most visible legacy to date. But the LET topnotchers, the international partnerships, the community recognitions, and the faculty tributes paint a fuller picture: a leader who understands that transforming an institution means transforming the people inside it, and that the most durable measure of a campus leader's work is what his graduates go on to do.

His story also carries meaning within the Bangsamoro context. A Maranao from Madalum, Lanao del Sur, who rose through the MSU System to become its VP for Finance and then a campus chancellor, Basar represents the kind of upward trajectory that the MSU System was originally designed to make possible for young Muslims in Mindanao.

<ref name="basar-resume">Basar, J. A. (n.d.). Professional Resume. MSU-MCEST Office of the Superintendent. Personal document on file.</ref>

<ref name="msu-system-website">Mindanao State University System. (2026). MSU System Constituent Colleges. Retrieved from https://www.msumain.edu.ph/msusys/</ref>

<ref name="msumcest-about">MSU Maigo College of Education, Science and Technology. (n.d.). About MSU-MCEST. Retrieved from https://msumcest.edu.ph/pages/about/mcest.php</ref>

<ref name="msumsat-officials">Campus Officials. MSU Maigo. Retrieved from https://msumsat.edu.ph/home/campus-officials.php</ref>

Further Reading

- Mindanao State University System. Official website: https://www.msumain.edu.ph
- MSU Maigo College of Education, Science and Technology. Official website: https://msumcest.edu.ph
- Commission on Higher Education (CHED). Licensure Examination for Teachers results, 2017--2025.

- Professional Regulation Commission (PRC). LET Topnotchers records.
- Marawi Siege (2017). Background reading for context on the MSU Crisis Team recognition.
- Islamic banking and finance in the Philippines: context for Basar's research on Islamic financing and Muslim women entrepreneurs.

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Mindanao State University Maigo College of Education, Science and Technology
- Lanao del Norte
- Lanao del Sur
- Maranao people
- Bangsamoro
- Licensure Examination for Teachers
- Integrated Bar of the Philippines
- Marawi Siege
- Mindanao State University Iligan Institute of Technology

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